

One answer is: Yes.

Physical properties can
cause phenomenal
properties, **and**

phenomenal properties can
cause physical properties.

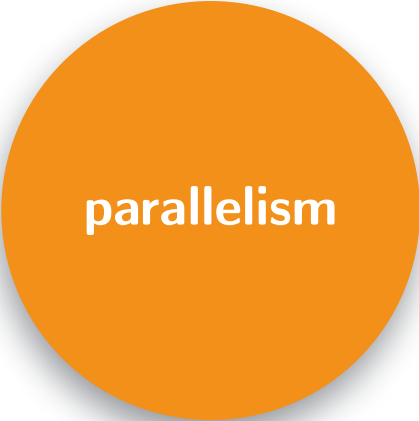
A second answer is: Yes.

Physical properties can
cause phenomenal
properties; **but** phenomenal
properties cannot cause
physical properties.

A third answer is: No.
Physical and phenomenal
properties cannot causally
interact.



interactionism

A large, solid orange circle is centered on a white background. The word "parallelism" is written in white, bold, lowercase letters across the middle of the circle.

parallelism



**epi-
phenomenalism**

Each of these views has its own strengths and weaknesses.

ANN FEELS HUNGER,
AND DECIDES TO
WALK TO THE
FRIDGE.

ANN HAS A VISUAL
SENSATION OF AN
APPLE AND DECIDES TO
EAT IT.

ANN TASTES THE APPLE
AND FEELS LESS
HUNGRY .

Let's start with the parallelist. This looks like the craziest of the
three views -- why would anyone hold it?





One reason for taking parallelism seriously is that causal connections between the physical and mental realms can look very puzzling.

A second argument is also simple. Once we think that there are no causal connections between the physical and mental worlds at all, why should we keep believing in a physical world at all?

This thought puts some pressure on the parallelist to become an
idealist, who denies that there is any physical world at all.



Here is what our causal chain looks like, according to the idealist.

There are no fridges, or doors, or apples, or walking -- just experiences as if there were such things. The fact that parallelism seems to lead to this sort of idealist view seems to many to be a reason to reject it.

phenomenal properties can

causal physical properties.

causaphenomenal

Physical properties can

One answer is: Yes.

properties, and

A second answer is: Yes.

properties cannot cause

properties; but phenomena

causal phenomena

physical properties.

Physical properties can

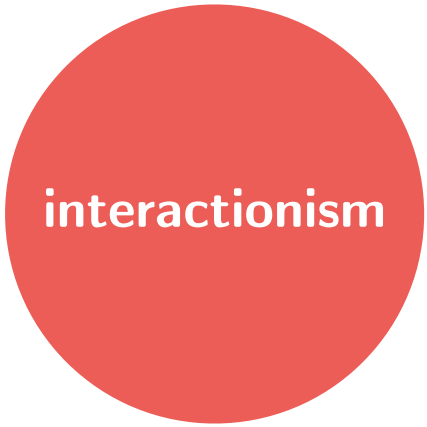
properties cannot causally

Physical and phenomenal

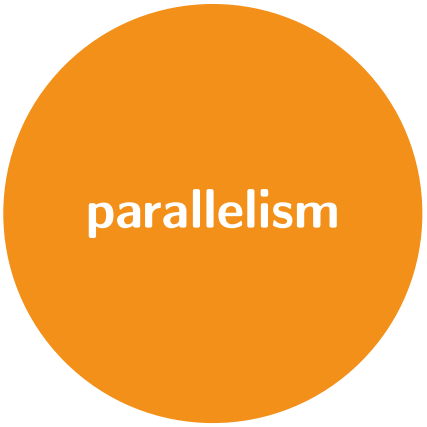
Third answer: No.



interact.



interactionism

A large, solid orange circle serves as the background for the entire image.

parallelism

epi-

phenomenalism

ANN FEELS HUNGER,
AND DECIDES TO
WALK TO THE
FRIDGE.

ANN HAS A VISUAL
SENSATION OF AN
APPLE AND DECIDES TO
EAT IT.

ANN TASTES THE APPLE
AND FEELS LESS
HUNGRY .

Let's start with the parallelist. This looks like the craziest of the

three views -- why would anyone hold it?

very puzzling.

One reason for taking parallelism seriously is that causal

connections between the physical and mental realms can look

A second argument is also simple. Once we think that there are no

usual connections between the physical and mental worlds at all, why

should we keep believing in a physical world at all?

idealist, who denies that there is any physical world at all.

This thought puts some pressure on the parallel to become

if there were such things. The fact that parallelism leads to this

sort of idealist view sees many to be a reason to reject it.

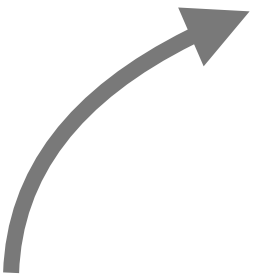
There are no fridges, no doors, or apples, or walking -- just experiences



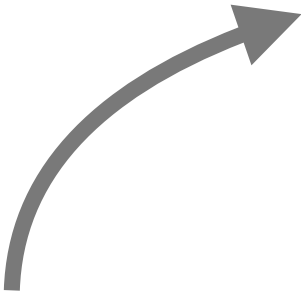








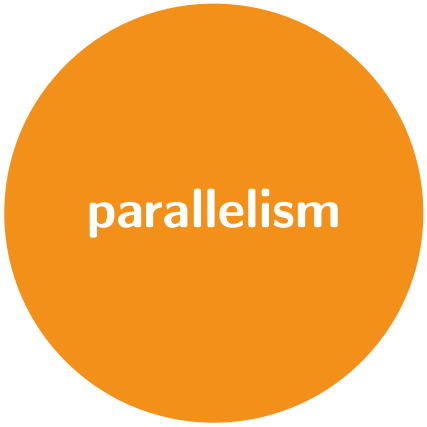








interactionism

A large, solid orange circle that fills the entire frame, serving as a background for the text.

parallelism